Backlink Automation — Wiring Your Stack to Google and Your Website

Your question: *Can this thing do the backlink between all my software back to my Google and my website?*

Short answer: **most of it, yes — and what can't be automated, you should still do manually because the SEO impact is real.** Here's what's automatable, what isn't, and what each actually does for ranking.

What "backlinks" mean for SEO

Two things are happening when people say "backlinks":

1. **External backlinks** — another website links to yours. These are the gold standard for SEO authority. Google reads them as "this site is endorsed by other sites."
2. **Internal cross-linking** — your own properties (gergacsrealty.com, savannahhomesandlifestylewithnik.com, gergacsappraisals.com, social profiles, GBP, YouTube descriptions) all point at each other in a coherent way. This isn't a backlink in the strict SEO sense, but it's how Google understands "this Realtor's authority spans these properties."

Both matter. The automation strategy below covers both.

What CAN be automated across your stack

1. Blog publish → social syndication (FULL AUTOMATE — Make scenario)

When you publish a new blog post on `savannahhomesandlifestylewithnik.com`, a Make scenario can automatically:

- Post a link to your Facebook page with a 2-paragraph teaser
- Post a link in your LinkedIn feed with a quote pulled from the post

- Add the post to a Metricool draft for Instagram Story (with link sticker)
- Update your IG bio link tree to include the latest post
- Schedule a YouTube Community post with the link
- Add to the next BoldTrail email newsletter
- Post to Google Business Profile as a “What’s New” post

What this gives you: every blog publish becomes 7+ inbound paths back to the post. Google reads consistent inbound traffic as authority signal. Visitors discover the same post from multiple touchpoints.

Build effort: ~3 hours for Muhammed using the Make platform. Once built, it runs automatically on every WordPress publish trigger.

2. Listing publish → cross-channel distribution (FULL AUTOMATE — Make scenario 04 from ops package)

Similar pattern for listings. Already specified in `make_scenarios/04_listing_launch.json`. Each new listing fires:

- iHomefinder sync (already automatic via MLS)
- WordPress blog draft creation
- Metricool 4-post schedule (Story + carousel + Reel + FB longform)
- BoldTrail email blast to saved-search-match contacts
- ManyChat broadcast to engaged followers

Why it’s a backlink play: every distribution channel includes a link back to gergacsrealty.com. Multiple high-quality inbound paths. Google notices.

3. YouTube video publish → blog cross-link (SEMI-AUTOMATE)

Every YouTube long-form gets:

- A blog post on `savannahhomesandlifestylewithnik.com` that EMBEDS the video and adds 800+ words of context
- A link from the YouTube video description back to that blog post
- Custom thumbnails and tags optimized for Savannah-area searches

Build effort: Manual workflow with checklist. Make can automate parts (creating the blog draft once a YouTube video uploads), but final-quality writing should stay human.

4. Email signature dynamic links (FULL AUTOMATE)

Set Outlook signature to include: - nikki@gergacsrealty.com - (912) 378-3427 - gergacsrealty.com (link) - savannahhomesandlifestylewithnik.com (link) - “Latest blog post: [dynamic link]” — manually update weekly OR pull via Make from your RSS feed

Why it’s a backlink: every email she sends is a tiny ambassador for site visits. Across 100 emails per week, this is meaningful traffic.

5. Google Business Profile posts (SEMI-AUTOMATE)

Google’s GBP API supports automated posting. Each blog publish can fire a GBP post with the link.

Why it matters: GBP posts factor into local search ranking. Frequent posts = stronger local SEO. Google strongly favors GBP profiles that are updated weekly+.

Caveat: GBP API has limits. Don’t spam-post — quality and rhythm matter more than volume.

6. Schema markup (ONE-TIME SETUP, then automatic)

The SEO audit identified that gergacsrealty.com has only `LocalBusiness` schema. You need:

- `RealEstateAgent` schema for Nikki personally
- `Person` schema with `sameAs` linking ALL her social profiles + websites
- `Place` schema for served markets
- `aggregateRating` once GBP reviews come in
- `Article` schema on every blog post (Yoast SEO Premium handles this automatically)

Why it’s a backlink play: schema explicitly tells Google “this Person is associated with these social profiles, these other websites, this license, this brokerage.” It’s like a backlink declaration of identity. Google uses it for Knowledge Panels, rich results, and authority calculation.

Build effort: One developer afternoon. Yoast Premium does most of it; the `Person` and `RealEstateAgent` JSON-LD blocks need to be customized once.

7. Internal linking on the lifestyle site (SEMI-AUTOMATE)

Yoast Premium has a feature called **internal linking suggestions**. When writing a new post, Yoast suggests existing posts to link to. Use it.

For deeper automation: - Set up a “related posts” widget at the bottom of every post - Build a hub-and-spoke content structure: cornerstone posts (#04 Pre-Listing Analysis, #07 Suburb Comparison) link out to spoke posts; spoke posts link back to cornerstones - Add “next read” suggestions inside long posts

This dramatically improves both user experience and Google’s understanding of your topic clusters.

8. Cross-link the three sites (MANUAL ONE-TIME, then maintenance)

Right now your three sites are silos. Fix the inter-linking:

- gergacsrealty.com → links to savannahhomesandlifestylewithnik.com (blog) and gergacsappraisals.com (appraisal practice)
- savannahhomesandlifestylewithnik.com → links to gergacsrealty.com (CTAs) and gergacsappraisals.com (when blog discusses appraisal)
- gergacsappraisals.com (once built) → links to gergacsrealty.com (for sales inquiries)

Footer block should be identical across all three: - All three URLs - Both phone numbers (or single primary) - Email address - License number - Brokerage affiliation - Pearl mark + tagline

Why: when Google crawls, it sees three sites consistently endorsing each other under the same brand. Not as strong as third-party backlinks, but free and high-confidence.

What CANNOT be automated (and why you should still do it)

1. Third-party authoritative backlinks

Real backlinks come from other websites linking to yours. These can’t be automated — they have to be earned or asked for. The high-leverage manual paths:

- **Local press placements.** Pitch the Savannah Morning News, Savannah Magazine, Coastal Living, regional real estate publications. One placement on a high-authority local site = months of paid SEO.
- **Guest posts on relocation sites.** Write a guest piece on a “Best Places to Retire” or “Where to Move From California” site. Backlink in author bio.
- **Realtor.com / Zillow agent profiles** with links back to your site. Free; powerful.

- **Local business chamber listings.** Savannah Area Chamber, etc.
- **Industry directories.** CRS, ABR, GRI directories if you carry those designations. NAR profile.
- **Better Business Bureau.** Free profile.
- **Local university or alumni associations** (Armstrong / Georgia Southern alumni directories if applicable).

2. Reviews on third-party platforms

- Google Business Profile (most important for local SEO)
- Zillow agent reviews
- Realtor.com reviews
- Facebook reviews
- Yelp (real estate) reviews

Each review is a soft backlink + trust signal. Lane 3 of the campaign (review sweep) handles getting these.

3. Local citations

A “citation” is any mention of your NAP (Name, Address, Phone) on another site, even without a direct link. They reinforce local SEO.

Build via free directory listings: - Yelp, Yellow Pages, Foursquare, Bing Places, Apple Maps, Mapquest - Real estate-specific: Realtor.com, Zillow, Trulia, Redfin - Industry: NAR.realtor, your brokerage’s site

Use a citation-building service (BrightLocal ~$40/mo) for the 50-listing initial build, then maintain manually.

4. Outreach for backlinks

- Reach out to Savannah lifestyle bloggers and pitch a “best Realtor” piece
- Connect with relocation services (corporate relocation companies) and request mention/link
- Offer your appraiser expertise to local journalists writing real estate stories
- Comment thoughtfully on industry blogs in your niche

This is genuine human work. It’s also the highest-yield SEO move available.

The full backlink automation map

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┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│              AUTOMATED CROSS-PROPERTY LINKING            │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘

  ┌──────────────┐   ┌──────────────┐   ┌──────────────┐
  │  WORDPRESS   │↔│   GERGACS    │↔ │  GERGACS     │
  │  Lifestyle   │   │   REALTY     │   │ APPRAISALS   │
  │    Site      │   │    Site      │   │ (TO BUILD)   │
  └──────┬───────┘   └──────┬───────┘   └──────┬───────┘
         │                  │                  │
         └──────────┬───────┴──────────┬───────┘
                    ↓                  ↓
            ┌──────────────┐   ┌──────────────┐
            │  SCHEMA      │   │  ONE NAP     │
            │  Person +    │   │  Footer      │
            │  RealEstate  │   │  block       │
            │  Agent       │   │  identical   │
            └──────┬───────┘   └──────┬───────┘
                   ↓                  ↓
            ┌──────────────────────────────┐
            │      sameAs links to:        │
            ├──────────────────────────────┤
            │ • Instagram                  │
            │ • Facebook page              │
            │ • LinkedIn profile           │
            │ • YouTube channel            │
            │ • TikTok                     │
            │ • Google Business Profile (x2) │
            │ • Realtor.com profile        │
            │ • Zillow agent profile       │
            │ • Brokerage page (Next Move) │
            └──────────────────────────────┘


  ┌──────────────────┐
  │ NEW BLOG PUBLISH │  (Trigger from WordPress webhook)
  └──────────┬───────┘
             ↓
        Make Scenario
             │
  ┌──────────┴──────────────────────────────────────┐
  ↓        ↓        ↓        ↓        ↓        ↓     ↓
  FB     LinkedIn  IG       YouTube   GBP    BoldTrail Outlook
  post   share     bio link Community post   newsletter signature
                   (link    post                        (auto-update
                   tree)                                with latest)


  ┌──────────────────┐
  │ NEW LISTING      │
```

```
    └──────────────────┘
              │
              ↓
        Make Scenario 04
              │
    Already specified in ops package
```

Build sequence (priority order)

PRIORITY	TASK	EFFORT	OWNER
P0	Fix schema (`Person` + `RealEstateAgent` JSON-LD)	2 hrs	Developer / Yoast support
P0	Unify NAP footer block across all 3 sites	1 hr	Muhammed
P0	Cross-link the 3 sites (header / footer / bio)	1 hr	Muhammed
P0	Claim both Google Business Profiles + add `sameAs` links	2 hrs	Nikki
P1	Build Make scenario: Blog publish → 7-channel syndication	3 hrs	Muhammed
P1	Build NAP-consistent listings on Realtor.com + Zillow + Facebook	1.5 hrs	Muhammed
P1	Citation-building sweep (50 free directories)	4 hrs (one-time)	Muhammed via BrightLocal
P2	Internal linking audit on lifestyle site (Yoast suggestions)	2 hrs	Nikki + Muhammed
P2	Outreach plan: 10 target sites for backlinks	6 hrs (research)	Nikki

PRIORITY	TASK	EFFORT	OWNER
P3	Build Make scenario: Listing publish → 7-channel + GBP post	4 hrs	Muhammed

Once P0 + P1 are live: every blog and every listing automatically generates 7-10 backlink/citation paths back to your sites. Multi-month SEO compound effect begins.

What success looks like at 6 months

- Domain authority on lifestyle site: noticeable improvement (verify via Moz / Ahrefs free check)
- 3-5 of the 10 blogs ranking in top 20 for target phrases
- 1-2 ranking in top 10
- GBP photos / posts updated weekly, not monthly
- 50+ Google reviews collected (Lane 3 of campaign)
- Realtor.com + Zillow profiles fully filled with reviews
- One press placement (Savannah Morning News, Savannah Magazine, or comparable)
- 30-50% increase in organic search traffic to your three sites combined

That's the SEO compound. No paid ads required.

What I'd do first this week

1. Audit and unify the NAP footer block on all three sites (1 hour)
2. Claim both Google Business Profiles + populate with photos + post weekly thereafter (2 hours initial setup)
3. Set up Yoast Premium internal linking suggestions on every blog draft going forward (already paid, just enable)

4. Get the schema markup audit done — `Person` + `RealEstateAgent` JSON-LD on gergacsrealty.com (developer afternoon)

That’s 4-5 hours of work this week that compounds for the next 12+ months. The Make-scenario automation can come in week 2.